CO2 – ASSESSMENT 2

SOCIAL ENGINEERING SIMULATION

Course: Ethical Hacking **Course Code:** ITA1406
Slot: Slot B **Total Marks:** 100
Course Faculty: Dr. K. Anbazhagan

Objective

To use search-engine operators to identify publicly indexed documents and official pages associated with an assigned organization, then evaluate what this publicly available information could reveal and how it may be misused in social engineering. The assignment lists 40 register-number-to-website mappings; the assigned domain depends on the student's register number.

Important assignment detail

The uploaded handout does not identify the student's register number. Therefore, the assigned company cannot be selected accurately. This report uses the literal placeholder **company.com** in the query examples and does not invent a company-specific result list. Replace the placeholder only conceptually when running the searches; actual links and counts require live search results.

1. Search techniques and commands

Use Google and replace company.com with the domain assigned to your register number in the handout (pages 1–2). The source spells some operators as “Diletype”; the standard Google operator is “filetype”.

Search queries

```
site:company.com filetype:pdf
site:company.com (filetype:ppt OR filetype:pptx)
site:company.com (filetype:doc OR filetype:docx)
site:company.com intitle:login
site:company.com inurl:admin
site:company.com "contact"
site:company.com "privacy policy"
```

2. Search query screenshot

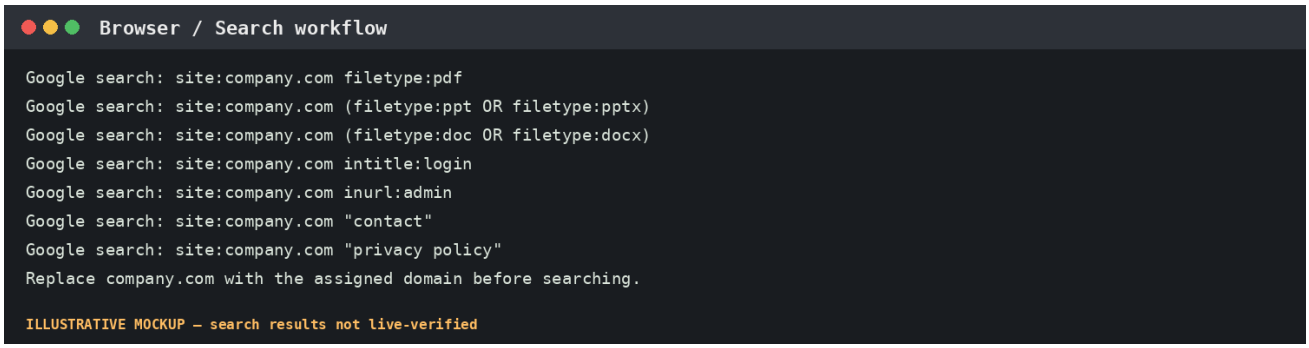


Figure 1. Illustrative search-query mockup, not a live Google results screenshot.

3. Answers to required table

Particular	Count	Links / findings
PDF Files	Not verified	Live Google results required for the assigned domain.
PPT Files	Not verified	Live Google results required for the assigned domain.
DOC Files	Not verified	Live Google results required for the assigned domain.
Login Pages	Not verified	Check results and confirm that each page is an official public page.
Admin Pages	Not verified	Search snippets do not prove an admin page is accessible. Do not attempt unauthorized access.
Contact Page	Not verified	Use the official website's Contact page; exact URL depends on assigned company.
Privacy Policy	Not verified	Use the official website's Privacy/Privacy Policy page; exact URL depends on assigned company.

4. Example findings screenshot

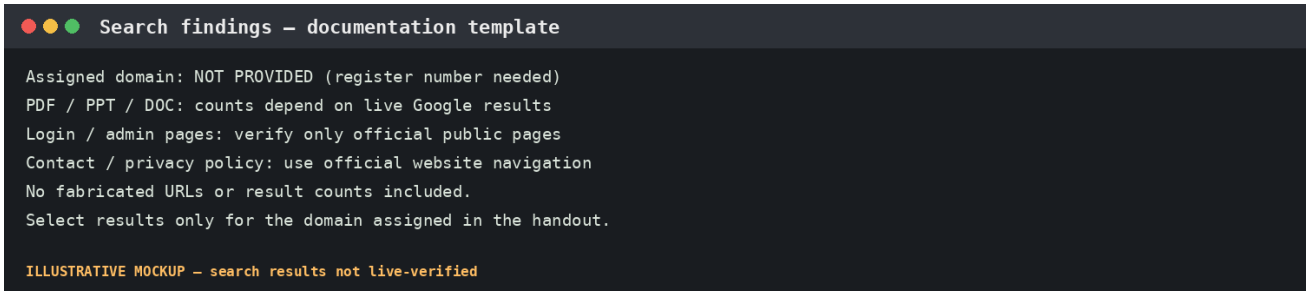


Figure 2. Illustrative documentation mockup. It contains no fabricated links or counts.

5. Security and social-engineering analysis

Public documents may disclose staff names, job titles, contact details, organizational terminology, internal project references, or metadata. A malicious actor could misuse such information to personalize phishing messages, impersonate employees or vendors, or make fraudulent requests appear credible. Public login pages may also help attackers identify authentication entry points, while exposed administrative interfaces may increase risk if poorly secured. The presence of a page or document alone does not establish a vulnerability.

Recommended countermeasures

- Train staff to identify phishing, impersonation, urgent payment requests, and suspicious attachments.
- Use multi-factor authentication (MFA), strong unique passwords, and a password manager.
- Review public documents before publication and remove unnecessary personal or internal metadata.
- Restrict administrative interfaces, enforce least privilege, and monitor authentication events.
- Publish clear verification procedures for payment, password-reset, and sensitive-data requests.
- Maintain accurate public contact and privacy pages, and report suspicious messages through approved channels.

6. Result

The required search operators have been identified and a structured results table has been prepared. Company-specific counts and links cannot be truthfully filled because the student's register number is not present in the supplied handout and no live search results were provided.

7. Conclusion

Search operators can efficiently locate publicly indexed information about an organization. Reviewing this information helps assess how it might support social engineering and what controls reduce the risk. Findings should be verified, documented accurately, and used only for authorized academic work.

8. References

- Original assignment: CO2 – Assessment 2, Social Engineering Simulation, Ethical Hacking, ITA1406, Slot B.
- Google Search Help: https://support.google.com/websearch/answer/2466433
- OWASP: https://owasp.org/

The original rubrics page from the supplied assignment is appended at the end.

RUBRICS

Criteria	Weightage (%)	Level 4 (Exemplary)	Level 3 (ProYicient)	Level 2 (Developing)	Level 1 (Beginning)
Search Technique Application	25%	Correctly applies all assigned search techniques and systematically investigates the assigned organization.	Applies most search techniques correctly with minor errors.	Applies some search techniques but requires guidance.	Unable to apply the required search techniques.
Information IdentiYication and Collection	25%	Accurately identiDies and records relevant documents, login pages, admin pages, contact pages, and privacy-policy information.	IdentiDies most relevant information with minor omissions.	IdentiDies limited information and misses several relevant Dindings.	Fails to identify meaningful information.
Security and Social Engineering Analysis	30%	Excellent analysis of how publicly available information could support social-engineering attacks and demonstrates strong security awareness.	Correctly identiDies most security implications and potential social-engineering risks.	IdentiDies some risks but provides limited technical interpretation.	Fails to recognize signiDicant social-engineering or information-exposure risks.
Documentation and Evidence	20%	Provides complete counts, links, lists, and well-organized evidence with clear technical documentation.	Provides adequate documentation with minor omissions.	Documentation is incomplete or lacks organization.	Documentation is poorly presented, incomplete, or lacks evidence.